

FURMAN UNIVERSITY GOSPEL ENSEMBLE CONSTITUTION 2018-2019

Purpose:

The Furman University Gospel Ensemble (FUGE) is a nondenominational organization whose purpose is to minister to people through the singing of Christian gospel and praise songs in the African American tradition. The choir ministers on campus, in area churches, and throughout the community. FUGE also serves as an instrument for the promotion of religious and cultural awareness and diversity.

Article I. Name of the Organization

The name of this organization will be the Furman University Gospel Ensemble (FUGE).

Article II. Membership

All Furman University students who have completed the FUGE Member Responsibility Contract and have paid the FUGE membership dues are considered members of FUGE. Every FUGE member is subject to the FUGE Constitution. No auditions are necessary. Non-Furman students are ineligible for membership.

Article III. Rehearsals

Rehearsals are 1 ½ to 2 hours, as needed. Rehearsal is a time for practicing together in preparation for a performance; it is not a social hour. Members are expected to attend all rehearsals (See Article V., Section I for exceptions).

Section I. Individual practice should be done at home to ensure a quick and productive rehearsal. Everyone is encouraged to have a recording of all the songs. Songs will be available on CDs, mp3s, and the FUGE email forum.

Section II. If a rehearsal is missed, it is the member's responsibility to acquire and learn missed material(s).

Article IV. Performances

The President or Secretary will inform members of a performance (during rehearsal and via email) at least two weeks in advance. Members are expected to participate in all performances.

Article V. Absences

Section I. Missed Rehearsals

- A. If two consecutive unexcused rehearsals are missed, members will not participate in the upcoming performance.
- B. If three consecutive unexcused rehearsals are missed, members will not be allowed to perform for the duration of the term.
- C. An absence is considered excused in case of illness or death in family.

Section II.

Tardiness and Early Departure

- A. Rehearsal will begin promptly at 7p.m. Three unexcused cases of tardiness will equal an unexcused absence. This unexcused absence will be considered consecutive to any other cases of tardiness or absences thereafter.
- B. An excused tardy is considered work, lab, or a mandatory organization meeting or practice.
 - Requests should be submitted to the secretary at least two hours in advance.
- C. Early Departure will be allowed if there is a University Event you are required to attend or participate in.
- D. Rules for tardiness also apply to Early Departure.

Section III.

Missed Rehearsals Preceding Concerts

- A. Each member is required to attend the last two rehearsals before a concert. If a member cannot attend, he or she must contact the Secretary at least 48 hours before rehearsal. If one of these rehearsals is missed and unexcused the member will not be able to participate in the concert.

Section IV.

Missed Performances

All absences must be reported to the Secretary at least 48 hours before a performance. The expectation of FUGE is that all members participate in all performances.

Article VI.

Membership Dues

A non-refundable annual fee, determined by the Executive board must be paid to the Treasurer by the predetermined deadline. Membership dues will be used to pay expenses not funded by Religious Council.

Article VII.

Yearly Theme

Each Executive Board will be responsible for developing a theme, which will serve as the direction and focus of the choir for that year.

Article VIII.

Songs

Section I. Song Submission

- A. Members desiring to present a song to the choir should bring the song to the Choir Director before the deadline predetermined by the Executive Board for approval.
- B. If approved, the Choir Director will give a copy of the lyrics to the Secretary and the recorded music to the Section leaders one week in advance.

Section II. Auditions

If a member would like to lead a song, he or she must audition. The Leader of the song will be determined at the discretion of the Choir Director.

Article IX. The Executive Board

The Executive Board is the governing body of FUGE. The Executive Board's purpose is to lead, organize, and direct its members in fulfilling the aforementioned goals and purposes of the organization. The Executive Board should receive all member complaints, investigate any problems, participate in all decisions affecting FUGE, and work in all possible ways to promote FUGE. The President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Religious Council Representative, and Fellowship Chair will be elected each spring by a process determined by the existing Executive Board. The Executive Board consists of:

Section I. **Advisor** - The advisor of FUGE will attend Executive Board meetings and assist with the planning of FUGE events. He or she will help with facilitating the organization, as well as actively supporting it. He or she is the Associate Director of Student Activities for Diversity Engagement or a Furman University faculty or staff member voted for by the Executive Board. He or she has the authority to appoint an Assistant Advisor.

Section II. **Choir Director** - The Choir Director is the acknowledged head of FUGE. He or she is a salaried employee of Furman University. The Choir Director must faithfully execute all provisions of the FUGE Constitution. He or she is expected to utilize his or her musical talents to instruct the choir. He or she is also responsible for determining the appropriateness of new material, based on style, content, and the choir's ability to perform the material. The Choir Director is expected to attend all rehearsals and Executive Board meetings. He or she has vetoing power and holds deciding vote in all Executive Board decisions.

Section III. **President** - The President will preside under the supervision of the Choir Director and under the Advisor in the absence of the Choir Director. He or she will act as coordinator for all performances, rehearsals, and Executive

Board meetings. The President should report to the Choir Director and the Advisor as circumstances merit. He or she will also act as a booking agent and schedule performances after consulting the Executive Board and the choir. The President is responsible for knowing all of the material to be performed and being capable of directing any song at any given time.

Section IV.

Vice President - The Vice President will preside over rehearsals in the absence of the President. He or she should assist the President with the coordination of all functions and handle all forms of publicity. The Vice President is responsible for submitting all applications for CLP credit and returning all CLP Board decisions. He or she will consult the Executive Board in the creation of programs for upcoming events.

Section V.

Secretary - The Secretary is responsible for all FUGE records. He or she must take attendance at all rehearsals and performances. The Secretary is the chief enforcer of the Attendance Policy; enforcement will include the sending of email reminders. He or she is responsible for making copies of song lyrics and programs and for keeping a record of the FUGE repertoire. The secretary is responsible for writing thank you notes to all of the churches that FUGE visits during the school year.

Section VI.

Treasurer/Religious Council Representative – The Treasurer is responsible for the financial aspects of FUGE. All money should be given to him/her. He or she shall consult the Executive Board in the submission of all new budget proposals to Religious Council and act as the chief enforcer of the Dues Policy. The treasurer is responsible for reconciling the FUGE checkbook with the monthly bank statement. The Treasurer must also serve as the Religious Council Representative and must attend all meetings held by RC. The Treasurer/RC Rep shall work to maintain the Religious Council Budget and be the chief liaison between the Religious Council and the choir.

Section VII.

Fellowship Chair –The Fellowship Chair is responsible for coordinating bonding experiences for the choir (get-togethers, cookouts, field trips, outings, etc.). Fellowship Chair is responsible for social media management.

Article X. Elections

Section I. Officers will be nominated by active members according to their capabilities in the Spring. Nominees are required to present a speech and will be voted on by active members and will be determined by the majority vote. In the event of a tie, the Choir Director shall cast the deciding vote.

Section II. Nominees must be active members.

Article XI. Additional Positions

The Executive Board may create additional positions or committees, as it deems necessary. The following are other positions of leadership within the choir outside of the Executive Board:

Section I. Section Leader – There will be section leaders in each section, appointed by the Choir Director. The Section Leader is responsible for knowing all of the material his or her section is to perform prior to the rehearsals. He or she must be patient, have “an ear for music,” attend Section Leader rehearsals, and be able to work with other members in his/her section.

Section II. Song Director – A Song Director must know the song thoroughly, be able to direct the choir in singing the song, and be willing to learn directing techniques, if necessary. He or she must audition for the director.

Section III. Band Leader- The Band Leader is responsible for leading the band instrumentally when playing songs and helping with techniques. The Band Leader will be appointed by the Choir Director.

Article XII. Article XI: Musicians

All musicians will be considered members of the organization and are thereby subject to the terms of membership including dues, attendance, and the constitution as outlined in Article II.

Article XIII. Attire

The Executive Board will determine appropriate attire for various occasions.

Revised 2014